REFERENCE GUIDE

Everything TradeJournal does, page by page.

TradeJournal is a self-hosted journal that syncs your closed trades from MT5 or cTrader, then helps you turn that history into an edge — through statistics, a chart-annotated pre-trade checklist, and a coach that looks for the psychological patterns behind your P&L.

---

12 sections **MT5 + cTrader** data sources **Owner & investor** access levels

00

Getting started

The shortest path from a fresh account to seeing your first synced trade on the Dashboard.

THE TWO WAYS TRADES GET IN

- **MT5** — via the free **Desktop Sync App**, a small Windows program that logs into your MT5 terminal in the background and pushes closed trades to your journal. It never places trades; it only reads history.
- **cTrader** — via an official OAuth connection. You approve access on cTrader's own site, and the journal pulls trade history, balances, and candlestick data directly from cTrader's API — no desktop app needed.

FIRST-TIME SETUP

1. **Create your account**

   Sign up with your name, email, and a password (8+ characters). You're taken straight to the Dashboard.

2. **Connect a broker account**

   Open Accounts in the sidebar and either add an MT5 login (you'll need its investor/read-only password) or connect cTrader through the OAuth button.

3. **Start syncing**

   For MT5: generate your personal sync key, install the Desktop Sync App, paste the key in, and click Start Sync. For cTrader: click Sync Now whenever you want fresh trades.

4. **Watch the Dashboard fill in**

   Balance, win rate, and the equity curve populate automatically once trades arrive. Everything else — journaling, playbooks, analytics — builds on top of that history.

> **GOOD TO KNOW** Trades themselves are **read-only** everywhere in the app — TradeJournal never edits your price, lot size, or P&L. What you add on top (notes, grades, playbook answers, screenshots, tags) is the "journal" part.

01 /

Dashboard

A live, auto-refreshing overview of account health — balance, edge metrics, cash flow, and the equity curve.

KEY METRICS

ACCOUNT BALANCE **Live from MT5/cTrader**	WIN RATE **+ avg win / avg loss**	EXPECTANCY **$ per trade**
AVG R **Trades with a recorded stop**	STREAKS **Current win / loss run**	DRAWDOWN **Current vs. max**
PROFIT FACTOR **Gross profit ÷ gross loss**		

CONTROLS

- **Time range** — All Time, Today, 7/30 Days, 3/6 Months.
- **View: Tickets vs. Setups** — Setups rolls re-entry trades up under their original parent, so a scaled-in position counts as one setup instead of three separate tickets.
- **Account selector** — appears once you've connected more than one broker account; scopes every number on the page to just that account.

CASH FLOW & EQUITY CURVE

- A running total of **Deposits**, **Withdrawals**, and **Net Cash Flow** for the selected range, with Deposit / Withdrawal buttons for logging manual cash movements (amount, date, note). Manually-logged entries can be deleted; entries synced from your broker cannot.
- The **Equity Curve** plots balance over time — hover any point for that day's exact balance and P&L.

MAINTENANCE TOOLS

- **Resync** — requests a fresh pull from your broker (the Desktop Sync App or cTrader connection needs to be active).
- **Remove duplicates** — de-dupes any doubled-up trade rows, with a confirmation first.

- **Fix Balances** — re-anchors every trade's running balance from a current MT5 balance you type in. Pick a single account first if you have more than one connected.

> **TIP** A warning banner appears whenever the numbers on screen are blending more than one broker account — balance and drawdown aren't meaningful mixed together, so switch to the account selector when you see it.

02 /trades

Trades

Your full trade log — and the place where journaling, playbook answers, and screenshots actually get attached to each trade.

FINDING TRADES

- Filter by **Symbol**, **Direction**, **Account type** (Live/Demo), **Trading account**, and a date range — filters are saved in the URL, so a filtered view can be bookmarked or shared.
- **Group by session** clusters trades under Tokyo / London / London–NY Overlap / New York / Pacific headers, each with its own trade count, net P&L, and win rate.
- Re-entries appear nested under their parent trade (indented, tagged "RE-ENT of #ticket"); trades sharing a position get a colored stripe down the left edge.

THE JOURNAL DRAWER

Click any row to open it. This is where a closed trade turns into a journaled one.

- **Post-Trade Review** — Analysis Grade and Execution Grade (A–F), scored separately so you can see when good analysis met poor execution, or vice versa.
- **Strategy Playbook** — attach a published playbook; your answers to its rule checklist are saved per-trade, organized into phase tabs with an "X / Y answered" counter. Rules that require a screenshot accept a pasted image (Ctrl+V) or file upload.
- **Inherit From Pre-Trade Analysis** — if you ran a Pre-Trade Analysis for this setup beforehand, one click pulls those answers and notes straight into the trade's journal.
- **Setup details** — setup type, confirmation tags, planned Risk:Reward, confidence score (1–10), exit reason, and whether you manually intervened on SL/TP.
- **Re-entry linking** — mark a trade as a re-entry, search for its parent by ticket number, and note why you re-entered. Re-entries skip the full playbook/notes section, since their result rolls into the parent's.
- **Trade Replay** — opens a candlestick chart of exactly what happened, with Prev/Next buttons to step to the next trade without closing the modal.

> **NOT HERE** There's no manual trade entry, price/lot editing, deletion, bulk actions, or CSV export on this page — trades are read-only records from your broker. (Full exports live under Backup.)

03 /calendar

Calendar

A month grid of daily P&L, for spotting the days and weeks that actually make or break your month.

- Monthly summary: **Net P&L**, **Consistency Score** (% of green days), **Best Day**, **Worst Day**.
- Each day cell shows trade count, net $ (green/red), and either avg R or win rate for that day.
- Filter by **Symbol**, **Setup Grade** (F is labeled "Boredom" setups), and **Trading account**.
- A weekly rollup strip below the grid totals each row's P&L and active trading days.
- Click any day with trades to open a drawer listing that day's trades, each with its own Replay button.

> **TIP** The small **"Jump to:"** date field does double duty — pick a date and it both flips the calendar to that month *and* opens that day's trade drawer in one step. Empty days aren't clickable, so nothing happens if you click a blank cell.

04 /stats

Analytics

Every dimension your history can be sliced by — instrument, session, direction, mood, grade, and time.

BREAKDOWNS AVAILABLE

P&L by session · Buy vs. sell · Setup grade · Emotional state · Strategy tags · P&L by pair · Win rate by pair · Day of week · Monthly P&L

- **Playbook Discipline** — the % of required playbook fields actually completed across your journaled trades; shown as a headline tile alongside Avg Trade Duration, Best Day, and Best Month.
- **Avg R / Avg Win (R) / Avg Loss (R)** — calculated only from trades where a stop-loss/risk value was recorded.
- **Psychology & Emotional Mindset Impact** — win rate and P&L broken out by the emotion you logged (Calm, Disciplined, Anxious, Greedy, Fearful, FOMO).
- **View**: Tickets vs. Setups, same as the Dashboard.
- **Date range**: All-Time, Today, 7/30 Days, 3/6 Months.
- **Account filter**: All accounts or one specific account.

> **NOTE** Grade, emotion, and tag breakdowns only populate once you've filled that field in on trades — each empty section tells you exactly what to log to unlock it (e.g. "assign a Setup Quality Grade in the journal drawer").

05 /performance

Performance

The risk and equity side of the story — where Analytics is categorical, Performance is financial.

NET P&L	PROFIT FACTOR	EXPECTANCY
+ % account growth	**Strong / Break-even / Losing**	**Avg $ per trade**

MAX DRAWDOWN
Excellent / Acceptable / High risk

- **Equity Curve** — account balance over time, with a reference line at your starting balance.
- **Drawdown Chart** — % decline from peak balance, for visualizing losing streaks.
- **Recent Trade P&L** — bar chart of your last ~40 individual results.
- **Risk Metrics** — 8 stats: win rate, avg win vs. avg loss, avg R:R, gross profit/loss, largest win/loss, max consecutive wins/losses.
- **Edge Summary** — an auto-written paragraph summarizing your edge in plain English, ending in a verdict: positive edge, marginal edge, or unprofitable system.

> **TIP** Long histories are automatically thinned to 300 chart points for readability — the underlying stats still use every trade.

06 /coach

Edge Coach

Diagnoses the psychology and discipline patterns behind your results — what's actually stopping you from executing your own plan.

WHAT IT SURFACES

- **Early Exits** — how many trades you closed before target, and the R/$ that likely cost you.
- **Plan Adherence** — % of your own execution checklist you actually followed, shown as a progress ring.
- **Analysis vs. Execution Grade Gap** — flags when your analysis quality outpaces your execution ("a psychology gap, not a strategy problem").
- **Manual Intervention** — compares outcomes on trades where you touched SL/TP mid-trade vs. left them alone.
- **Demo vs. Live Comparison**, **Strategy Versions** (performance per published playbook version, so edits don't blend with old results), and **Lifecycle Stage Compliance**.
- **What Works — Rule Evidence** — win rate per specific playbook answer, tagged strong / developing / insufficient by sample size.
- **Confidence vs. Actual Win Rate** — tests whether your gut-feel confidence rating actually predicts outcomes.

> **NOTE** Almost every panel here only appears once you've logged the field it depends on (exit reason, grades, confidence rating, live/demo tag…). This page rewards thorough journaling more than any other.

07 /rules

Playbooks

Build the rulebook your trades get measured against — a versioned checklist spanning a trade's full lifecycle.

THE NINE LIFECYCLE STAGES

1 Concept · 2 Market context · 3 Setup & location · 4 Entry confirmation · 5 Risk plan · 6 Execution · 7 Trade management · 8 Exit · 9 Post-trade review

BUILDING A STRATEGY

- **New strategy** starts a blank draft — nothing saves until you publish.
- Add a stage via **Add recommended stage** (pre-filled with 3 starter rules for that category) or **Add empty stage**. Stages can be renamed, reordered, recategorized, or removed.
- **Add rule** inside any stage: set its label, answer type (Yes/No, Number, Text, Single/Multiple choice — with sub-formats like Percentage, Currency, R:R, Duration, Rating, Date/Time), and whether it's required.
- Each rule's **More options** panel holds: tool role (Observation, Confirmation, Entry trigger, Decision gate, Invalidation, Risk limit, Management action, Exit signal, Review prompt), what happens when it's not satisfied (record only / warn / skip trade / stop session), applicable timeframes, help text, and a **trade-screenshot requirement** with min/max image counts.
- Stages and rules can each carry optional reference example images to teach what a "valid" vs. "invalid" setup looks like.

PUBLISHING

- Every block/rule needs a name, and you must write a **change note of at least 20 characters** describing what changed and why — this becomes a permanent part of that version's record.
- Publishing creates a new **immutable version**; older versions are never overwritten, so past trades keep pointing at the exact checklist they were judged against.
- **Archive** retires a strategy without deleting its history. **Read playbook** opens a clean, read-only view of the published version.

> **TIP** The strategy panel lists any **open Pre-Trade Analyses** already started against it, so you can jump back into one mid-setup instead of starting over.

08 /pretrade

Pre-Trade Analysis

Run your playbook's checklist *before* you enter — on a live chart you can draw on — then carry the answers into the real trade once it's taken.

STARTING ONE

- From Playbooks, click **Start Pre-Trade Analysis** on any strategy. It locks in that strategy's current published version and shows only its **Plan-phase** stages — Concept, Market context, Setup, Entry confirmation, and Risk plan — since Execution/Management/Exit/Review can't apply before a trade exists.
- Answer the same rule checklist you'd fill in on a real trade. Screenshot-required rules simply note that confirmation will be requested later, once inherited into an actual trade.

THE CHART

A candlestick chart loads for whatever symbol you type — with the same drawing toolset as Trade Replay, so you can mark up key levels yourself instead of the app guessing them for you.

`Zone (rectangle)` `Trend line` `Price level` `Arrow` `Text note` `Image evidence` `Select / move` `Undo` `Delete`

- Type a symbol and a **datalist** suggests real names from your connected broker account, so you're not guessing a spelling like "USTEC" vs. "NAS100" vs. "US100" yourself.
- Choose a **timeframe** (1m–1D) and **lookback window** (2–30 days) to bring the right amount of history into view.
- Use the drawing tools to mark **Previous Day High/Low**, **Previous Week High/Low**, and the **Asian / London session** highs and lows — then look for price to either **sweep** through one (a liquidity grab that reverses) or **continue** through it (a breakout).
- Everything — chart symbol, timeframe, and every annotation — **autosaves** a moment after you stop drawing.

BRINGING IT INTO A REAL TRADE

- When the trade actually happens and syncs in, open its Journal Drawer and use **Inherit From Pre-Trade Analysis** to pull the playbook answers and notes across in one click.

BY DESIGN TradeJournal never calculates PDH/PDL or session levels for you — marking them is a manual, deliberate act, the same way you'd draw on a chart in your trading platform. The chart just gives you a canvas.

09 /knowledge

Knowledge Base

A free-form, searchable notebook for anything that isn't tied to one specific trade — broker quirks, market-structure ideas, session notes.

- **New Entry** opens a drawer with a Title, free-text Notes body, and comma-separated Tags.
- A live search box filters entries by title/content as you type.
- Entries display as cards: title, a short preview, tags, screenshot count, and date.
- Attach screenshots by uploading a file — or by **pasting an image straight from your clipboard** (Ctrl+V) while the entry drawer is open.

> **ORDER MATTERS** A brand-new entry has to be saved once before you can attach screenshots to it — the drawer will prompt you to save first.

10 /accounts

Accounts & syncing

Where every broker connection, the Desktop Sync App, and investor access are all managed.

CONNECTING MT5

1. **Add account**

   Give it a label, your MT5 login number, broker server, and your MT5 *investor* (read-only) password — never your trading password. Optionally map journal symbol names to broker-specific ones (e.g. `XAUUSD:XAUUSDm`) under Advanced symbol mapping.

2. **Generate your sync key**

   Under "Your personal sync key," click Generate / rotate. It's shown once — copy it immediately.

3. **Install the Desktop Sync App**

   Download it, paste in your sync key, and click Start Sync. This small Windows app is what actually logs into MT5 and pushes trades in the background — the account record alone doesn't sync anything by itself.

CONNECTING CTRADER

- **Connect cTrader** redirects to cTrader's own OAuth approval page. On return, pick which of your cTrader accounts under that login to actually connect.
- Each connected account gets **Sync Now** (pulls new trades and deposits/withdrawals) and **Disconnect** (stops syncing; already-synced trades stay in your history).
- cTrader is also what powers **Trade Replay's** candlestick charts and the Pre-Trade Analysis chart — it matters even if your trade history itself comes from MT5.

ACCOUNT CARDS

Each card shows connection status (Connected / Needs attention / Waiting for agent / Disabled), trade count, balance, last sync time, and a sync on/off toggle. MT5 cards can be edited or archived directly; cTrader cards are managed through the cTrader section instead.

SHARING INVESTOR ACCESS

Per account, not global — expand the **Investor** panel on any account card.

- **Enable investor access** generates a numeric account code and a one-time password (shown once, like the MT5 investor password).

- **Copy investor link** gives you a shareable `/investor/login` URL; copy the password separately and send it through a different channel.
- **Rotate password** issues a new one (the old one stops working immediately); **Revoke access** disables the link entirely.

11 /archive

Backup & export

Health-check your stored data and pull a full export — this page reads and downloads, it doesn't restore.

- **Database Status** — live badge: Database Connected, or Offline (Local Cache) if the app has fallen back to a local copy. Shows total trades, account events, and your oldest/latest trade dates.
- **Local JSON Mirror** — the server automatically mirrors all trade data to its own disk on startup and every 24 hours, as a safety net if the live database goes down.
- **Screenshot redundancy** — every screenshot is backed by three layers: metadata embedded in the image itself, a sidecar metadata file, and offline disk storage that auto-uploads once you're back online.
- **Download JSON** — a full backup (trades, account events, screenshot URLs) suitable for restoring into a fresh database.
- **Download CSV** — trade fields formatted for Excel or Sheets.

> **ONE-WAY ONLY** There's no restore/import button on this page, even though the JSON export is restore-capable. Treat this page as export-only.

12 /investor

Investor mode

A no-signup, read-only window into one specific account's performance — for a partner, fund investor, or anyone you report to.

LOGGING IN AS AN INVESTOR

Two fields, no email or account needed: the numeric **Account Number** (the code the owner shared) and the one-time **Password**. The login page states plainly: read-only, no changes possible.

WHAT THE INVESTOR SEES

BALANCE	WIN RATE	MAX DRAWDOWN
Live	**+ profit factor**	**Color-coded**

AVG WIN / LOSS
+ expectancy

- An equity curve chart, and a table of up to 50 recent closed trades.
- A **Replay** button per trade opens a candlestick chart with a full playback bar: play/pause, step, jump-to-entry/exit, a 0.5×–10× speed selector, and a scrubbable progress bar.

`Space` play / pause `← / →` step candle `E` jump to entry `X` jump to exit

> **BOUNDARIES** An investor session can't reach any other page — no accounts, no playbooks, no journal notes, no other accounts you own — and can't edit or upload anything. It's a separate login token from your own, so it can't be reused to access the owner side of the app.

Glossary & quick reference

Terms that show up across the app without much explanation in the moment.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
R / Avg R	Result measured as a multiple of what you risked. A trade risking $100 that made $250 is "2.5R." Only calculated for trades with a recorded stop.
Setup vs. Ticket	A "ticket" is one broker execution; a "setup" groups a ticket with any of its re-entries so scaled-in positions count once.
PDH / PDL	Previous Day High / Previous Day Low — a key level to watch for a sweep or continuation.
PWH / PWL	Previous Week High / Previous Week Low — the same idea, one timeframe up.
Sweep	Price pushes briefly past a level to grab liquidity, then reverses — as opposed to a genuine breakout.
Continuation	Price breaks a level and keeps going in that direction.
Plan Adherence	% of your own execution checklist you actually followed on a trade.
Analysis vs. Execution Grade	Two separate A–F scores — how good your read was, versus how well you carried it out.
Sample status	Edge Coach tags evidence as strong / developing / insufficient based on how many trades back it up — a built-in caution against small-sample conclusions.
Investor password	A broker or TradeJournal password that only ever grants read access — shown once, never retrievable again after that.
Playbook version	An immutable snapshot of a strategy's rules, created every time you publish — past trades keep pointing at the exact checklist they were judged against.